

Word family: **travel / travels / travelled / traveled / travelling / traveling / traveller / traveler / well-travelled / well-traveled / travelogue**

Base word: travel

Verb forms: travel, travels, travelled/traveled, travelling/traveling

Noun: travel

Person noun: traveller/traveler

Useful family extensions: well-travelled/well-traveled, travelogue

Common compounds: business travel, air travel, travel agency, travel agent, travel insurance, travel document, travel sickness, travel restrictions

Part of speech: verb (動詞) / noun (名詞)

Your sentence:

> “I still use them now, especially when I am **travelling** or trying to focus.”

A full family sweep shows that **travel has one strong central concept—movement from one place to another—but it extends naturally beyond people to vehicles, light, sound, information, objects, and mechanical movement.** We should group those related movement senses rather than pretend they are all unrelated.

Meaning in this passage

Here, **travelling** means:

making a journey or moving from one place to another, especially away from home for some period of time.

繁體中文: **正在出行／旅行，在不同地方之間移動**

Natural translation:

> “I still use them now, especially when I am travelling or trying to focus.”

「我現在仍然會使用它們，尤其是在**旅行／出行途中**或想集中精神的時候。」

Here:

travel = 從一個地方前往另一個地方，通常涉及一段路程

1. **travel from/to/between + place (地點) — 旅行; 出行; 前往**

This is your original meaning.

****Meaning:**** To go from one place to another, especially over some distance.

Practice 1 — Original

> “I use the headphones when I am ****travelling****.”

「我****旅行／出行途中****會使用這副耳機。」

Practice 2

> “She ****travels**** to London regularly for work.”

「她經常因工作而****前往倫敦****。」

Practice 3

> “We ****travelled**** across Japan by train.”

「我們乘火車****遊歷了日本各地****。」

****travel = 從一個地方移動到另一個地方，通常涉及較明顯的路程或旅程****

2. ****travel = go on journeys generally (一般旅行活動) — 旅行; 四處遊歷****

Here the emphasis is not one particular destination but the activity of travelling.

Practice 4

> “I love to ****travel****.”

「我很喜歡****旅行****。」

Practice 5

> “She ****travels**** a lot for her job.”

「她因工作而經常****到不同地方出差／旅行****。」

****travel = 進行旅行或經常前往不同地方的活動****

This belongs to the same core sense as #1.

3. **travel by + transport (交通工具) — 乘.....出行**

Practice 6

> “We usually **travel by train**.”

「我們通常**乘火車出行**。」

Practice 7

> “It is often cheaper to **travel by bus**.”

「**乘巴士出行**通常比較便宜。」

travel by + transport = 以某種交通工具完成旅程

Notice:

> **travel by train** 

> **travel on a train**  but different structure

4. **travel + distance/direction (距離／方向) — 移動; 行進**

The subject does not have to be a person.

Practice 8

> “The car **travelled** several kilometres before stopping.”

「汽車在停下之前**行駛了幾公里**。」

Practice 9

> “The ball **travelled** across the floor.”

「那個球**滾動／移動過地面**。」

travel = 人、車輛或物件從一個位置移動到另一個位置

This is still the same movement concept.

5. **sound/light/waves travel (聲音／光／波) — 傳播; 傳遞**

A major scientific and everyday extension.

Practice 10

> “Sound **travels** through air.”

「聲音會透過空氣**傳播**。」

Practice 11

> “Light **travels** much faster than sound.”

「光的**傳播速度**比聲音快得多。」

travel — sound/light/waves = 能量或波從一處向另一處傳播

This is not literal human travel, but the underlying idea is still **movement through space**.

6. **news/information/rumours travel (消息／資訊／傳聞) — 傳開; 流傳**

A figurative extension of movement.

Practice 12

> “News **travels** fast in a small town.”

「消息在小鎮裡**傳得很快**。」

Practice 13

> “The rumour quickly **travelled** through the office.”

「那個傳聞很快就在辦公室裡**傳開了**。」

travel — information = 消息、資訊或傳聞由一個人／地方迅速傳到其他人／地方

Same core metaphor: ****movement from source to destination****.

7. ****food/object/product travel well**(物品／食物) — 經運送後仍保持良好狀態******

A useful expression.

Practice 14

> “This cake ****travels well****.”

「這種蛋糕很適合運送，****經過旅程後仍能保持良好狀態****。」

Practice 15

> “Some wines do not ****travel well****.”

「有些葡萄酒****經長途運送後品質容易受影響****。」

****travel well** = 某件物品在運送、搬動或長途旅程後仍保持良好品質／狀態******

8. ****idea/style/product travel well**(構思／文化／作品) — 在不同地方／文化中仍適用或受歡迎******

A more figurative extension.

Practice 16

> “Good comedy does not always ****travel well**** across cultures.”

「好的喜劇不一定能在不同文化之間****同樣容易被理解和接受****。」

Practice 17

> “The design has ****travelled well**** internationally.”

「這種設計在不同國家和市場都****能夠被接受並保持吸引力****。」

****travel well — figurative** = 某種構思、風格或作品進入不同地方／文化後仍然有效、受歡迎或容易理解******

9. **travel = movement of a mechanical part (機械零件) — 行程; 移動距離**

This is a technical but reasonably common modern sense.

For example, in keyboards, suspension, brakes, pedals, buttons, etc., **travel** means how far a part moves.

Practice 18

> “The keyboard has very short key **travel**.”

「這個鍵盤的按鍵**按壓行程很短**。」

Practice 19

> “The suspension offers more **travel** on rough terrain.”

「這套懸掛系統在崎嶇地面上提供較大的**懸掛行程**。」

travel — mechanical = 零件從原來位置移動到另一位置時所經過的距離／行程

This is genuinely distinct enough to recognize.

10. **travel = activity of travelling (名詞, 不可數) — 旅行; 出行**

Here, **travel** is a noun.

Practice 20

> “Air **travel** has become more expensive.”

「航空**旅行／出行**變得更昂貴。」

Practice 21

> “Business **travel** is part of her job.”

「商務**出差／旅行**是她工作的一部分。」

travel — noun = 從一個地方前往另一個地方這種活動的總稱

Usually uncountable:

> **Travel** is expensive. 

Not normally:

> **a travel** 

11. **travels** = journeys/experiences in different places (複數名詞) — 遊歷; 旅途經歷

Travels can be used for a person's journeys collectively, often with a slightly literary or narrative tone.

Practice 22

> “He wrote a book about his **travels** in Africa.”

「他寫了一本關於自己在非洲**遊歷經歷**的書。」

Practice 23

> “She collected these objects during her **travels**.”

「她在各地**旅行期間**收集了這些物品。」

travels = 一個人在不同地方的多次旅程和遊歷經歷

Compare:

> **travel** = 旅行這種活動

> **travels** = 某人的多次遊歷／旅途經歷

12. **traveller / traveler** = person who travels (旅行者) — 旅客; 旅行者

British spelling:

> **traveller**

American spelling:

> **traveler**

Practice 24

> “The hotel is popular with business **travellers**.”

「這間酒店很受商務**旅客**歡迎。」

Practice 25

> “Experienced **travelers** often pack lightly.”

「有經驗的**旅行者**通常不會帶太多行李。」

traveller/traveler = 正在旅行或經常旅行的人

13. **well-travelled / well-traveled** = having travelled widely — 遊歷廣泛的; 去過很多地方的

Practice 26

> “She is very **well-travelled**.”

「她**去過很多地方、旅遊經驗非常豐富**。」

Practice 27

> “He is a **well-traveled** journalist.”

「他是一名**遊歷廣泛、去過很多地方的記者**。」

well-travelled person = 曾到過很多不同地方、擁有豐富旅行經驗的人

British:

> **well-travelled**

American:

> **well-traveled**

14. **well-travelled / well-traveled + road/route** (道路／路線) — 經常有人使用的; 交通頻繁的

Same form, different contextual application.

Practice 28

> “It is a well-travelled road.”

「這是一條**經常有人使用、交通流量較大的道路**。」

Practice 29

> “They followed a well-travelled route through the mountains.”

「他們沿著一條**很多旅客走過的常用山路**前進。」

well-travelled route = 經常有人通行或使用的路線

15. **travelogue = book/film/programme about travel — 遊記; 旅行紀錄作品**

A useful lexical family extension that should not be missed.

Practice 30

> “She wrote a **travelogue** about her journey through South America.”

「她寫了一本關於南美旅程的**遊記**。」

Practice 31

> “The programme is part documentary and part **travelogue**.”

「這個節目部分是紀錄片，部分是**旅行紀錄節目**。」

travelogue = 以旅行經歷、地方和沿途見聞為內容的書籍、文章、電影或節目

This is a **family-extension word**, not another sense of the verb **travel**.

Important distinction: **travel vs trip**

This is extremely important.

travel

usually refers to the **general activity of travelling** and is often uncountable.

> “I enjoy travel.”

「我喜歡旅行。」

trip

a specific journey/event.

> “I went on a trip to Japan.”

「我去日本旅行了一趟。」

So:

> **a trip** ✓

> **a travel** ✗ normally

Important distinction: **travel vs journey**

travel

= the general act/activity of moving between places

journey

= one particular movement from one place to another, often focusing on the process/time spent travelling

> “The journey took five hours.”

「那段旅程花了五個小時。」

> “Travel can be tiring.”

「旅行有時很累。」

Important distinction: **trip vs journey**

trip

often includes the whole visit/event:
going somewhere + spending time there + returning.

> “a business trip”

「商務旅行／出差」

journey

focuses more on moving from point A to point B.

> “The train journey took three hours.”

「火車車程用了三小時。」

Important distinction: **travel vs tour**

tour

usually involves visiting several places, often according to a planned route.

> “We toured several cities.”

「我們遊覽了幾個城市。」

A musician may also:

> “go on tour”

= 到不同地方巡迴演出

So **tour** is more specific than **travel**.

Important distinction: **travel vs commute**

You previously used **commuting** in this passage.

travel

broad movement between places.

commute

regularly travel between home and work/school.

> “I travel a lot.”

「我經常到不同地方出行／旅行。」

> “I commute to work by train.”

「我每天乘火車通勤上班。」

All commuting involves travel, but not all travel is commuting.

Important distinction: **travelling vs traveling**

Both are correct.

British English

* travelled

* travelling

* traveller

American English

* traveled

* traveling

* traveler

Your sentence uses:

> **travelling**

which follows the standard British spelling pattern.

Important grammar note: **travel is usually uncountable as a noun**

Correct:

> “Travel is expensive.”

> “business travel”

> “air travel”

Normally not:

> *a travel* ❌

> *many travels* ❌ for ordinary individual trips

Instead use:

> “a trip”

> “several journeys”

But **travels** is possible when referring collectively to someone's adventures:

> “his travels in Europe”

= 他在歐洲的遊歷

Useful compounds from the family sweep

These are common and worth recognizing:

* **air travel** = 航空旅行

* **business travel** = 商務旅行／出差

* **travel agent** = 旅行社代理人／旅遊顧問

* **travel agency** = 旅行社

* **travel insurance** = 旅遊保險

* **travel document** = 旅行證件

* **travel restrictions** = 旅行限制／出入境限制

* **travel sickness** = 暈車／暈船等旅行暈動症

* **travel expenses** = 差旅費

* **travel guide** = 旅遊指南

* **travel companion** = 旅伴

One particularly useful expression:

travel light = 輕裝旅行；少帶行李

> “I prefer to **travel light**.”

「我旅行時喜歡**輕裝上陣**、**少帶行李**。」

This is a common fixed expression and deserves inclusion.

Family-extension sweep

After the full sweep, the useful modern family is:

- * **travel — verb** = 旅行; 前往; 移動
- * **travel — sound/light** = 傳播
- * **travel — news/information** = 傳開
- * **travel well — object** = 經運送後保持良好狀態
- * **travel well — idea/culture** = 在不同地方／文化中仍適用
- * **travel — mechanical** = 零件移動行程
- * **travel — noun** = 旅行這種活動
- * **travels** = 遊歷／旅途經歷
- * **traveller/traveler** = 旅行者／旅客
- * **well-travelled/well-traveled** = 遊歷廣泛的; 道路常被使用的
- * **travelogue** = 遊記／旅行紀錄作品
- * **travel light** = 輕裝旅行
- * useful compounds such as **travel insurance, travel agency, travel sickness**

I would not add obscure technical derivatives merely because they contain **travel**.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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travel — person	從一個地方前往另一個地方, 通常涉及一段較明顯的路程
travel — general activity	進行旅行或經常前往不同地方的活動
travel — vehicle/object	車輛或物件從一個位置向另一位置移動
sound/light travels	聲音、光或其他波從一處向另一處傳播
news/information travels	消息或資訊由一個人／地方傳到其他人／地方
travel well — physical object	經搬運或長途運送後仍能保持良好品質／狀態
travel well — figurative	構思、作品或風格進入不同地方／文化後仍能被接受或發揮效果
travel — mechanical	機械零件從原位置移動到另一位置的距離／行程
travel — noun	從一個地方前往另一個地方這種活動的總稱

travels	某人在不同地方的多次旅程和遊歷經歷	
traveller/traveler	正在旅行或經常旅行的人	
well-travelled person	去過很多不同地方、旅行經驗豐富的人	
well-travelled route	經常有人通行或使用的道路／路線	
travelogue	以旅行經歷和地方見聞為內容的書籍、文章、影片或節目	
travel light	旅行時只帶少量必要行李	

For your original sentence

> “I still use them now, especially when I am ****travelling**** or trying to focus.”

The exact meaning is:

****travelling = 正在從一個地方前往另一個地方／正在旅行或出行途中****

And in this headphone context, it naturally suggests situations such as:

****乘火車、飛機、巴士或其他交通工具出行時****

So the most natural translation is:

> ****「我現在仍然會使用它們，尤其是在旅行／出行途中或想集中精神的時候。」****